

DECAISNEA

Has blue-bloomed shoots and large, deep green leaves of paired leaflets. Racemes of greenish flowers in early summer are followed by pendent, sausage-shaped, bluish fruits. Z7–9

DECUMARIA

HYDRANGEACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous, woody-stemmed, root climbers. Prefers sun and loamy, well-drained soil that does not dry out. Prune, if necessary, after flowering. Propagate by stem cuttings in late summer or early fall.

D. barbara. Deciduous climber. H to 30ft (10m). Has ovate to ovate-oblong, glossy, dark green leaves. In summer, produces rounded, terminal clusters, 5⁄16in (1.5cm) across, of small, white flowers each with a central “brush” of white or creamy-white stamens. Z6–9

D. sinensis illus. p.192.

DEINANTHE

HYDRANGEACEAE

Genus of slow-growing perennials with creeping, underground rootstocks. Useful for rock gardens and peat beds. Needs shaded, moist soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed when fresh.

D. bifida illus. p.264.

D. caerulea. Slow-growing, mound-forming perennial. H 8in (20cm), S to 6in (15cm). Stems, each bearing a cluster of nodding, bowl-shaped, pale violet-blue flowers, rise above 3–4 ovate, toothed leaves in summer. Z5–9

Delairea odorata. See *Senecio mikanioides*.

DELOSPERMA

AIZOACEAE

Genus of evergreen or semievergreen, succulent shrubs and mat-forming, succulent perennials. Frost tender. Requires full sun and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

D. cooperi (Ice plant). Spreading, mat-forming, perennial succulent. H 2in (5cm), S indefinite. Has cylindrical, fleshy, light green leaves, 2in (5cm) long, and, in mid-to late summer, solitary, daisylike, magenta flowers. Z8–10

DELPHINIUM

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of perennials, biennials, and annuals, grown for their spikes of irregularly cup-shaped, sometimes hooded, spurred flowers. Needs an open, sunny position and fertile or rich, well-drained soil. Tall cultivars need staking and ample feeding and watering in spring and early summer. In spring, remove thin growths from well-established plants, leaving 5–7 strong shoots. If flower spikes are removed after they fade, a second flush may be produced in late summer, provided plants are fed and watered well. Propagate species by seed in fall or spring; Belladonna Group cultivars by division or basal cuttings of young shoots in spring; Elatum Group cultivars by cuttings only. ☉ All parts may

cause severe discomfort if ingested, and contact with foliage may irritate skin. See also feature panel p.217.

For ease of reference, delphinium cultivars have been grouped as follows:

Belladonna Group. Upright, branched perennials with palmately lobed leaves. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S to 18in (45cm). Wiry stems bear loose, branched spikes, 1ft (30cm) long, of elf cap-shaped, single flowers, 3⁄16in (2cm) or more across, with spurs up to 1⁄4in (3cm) long, in early and late summer.

Elatum Group. Erect perennials with large, palmate leaves. H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S 24–36in (60–90cm). In summer, produce closely packed spikes, 16in–4ft (40cm–1.2m) long, of regularly spaced, semidouble, rarely fully double flowers, 3–4in (8–10cm) across, in a range of colors from white to blue and purple, sometimes red-pink, usually with contrasting eyes.

Pacific Hybrids. Similar to Elatum Group cultivars, but grown as annuals or biennials. They produce spikes of short-lived, large, semidouble flowers in early and mid-summer.

University Hybrids. Erect, branched herbaceous perennials with palmately lobed, mid-green leaves. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S to 18in (45cm). In summer, stems bear loose, branched spikes of large, semi-double or double flowers in a range of colors in shades of red, orange or pink. Plants need careful cultivation to succeed.

D. ‘Alice Artindale’ (illus. p.217). Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m). Produces neat, buttonlike, fully double, bicolor, rosy-mauve and sky-blue flowers, to 1⁄4in (3cm) across, in narrow spikes, 20–24in (50–60cm) or more long, in early to midsummer. Z3–7

D. ‘Ann Woodfield’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m). Bears semidouble, pale blue flowers, to 4in (10cm) across, suffused pale mauve, in tapering spikes, to 3ft (1m) long, in midsummer. Z3–8

D. ‘Atlantis’. Vigorous, Belladonna Group herbaceous perennial. H 4½ft (1.4m), S 20in (50cm). Produces spikes of mauve-flushed, deep blue flowers, 1¼in (3cm) across, in midsummer. Has dark green leaves. Z3–8

D. ‘Blue Dawn’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 8ft (2.4m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 4ft (1.2m) long, of pale blue flowers, to 3in (7cm) across, with dark brown eyes. Z3–7

D. Blue Fountains Group. Short-lived, Pacific Hybrids herbaceous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m). In early to midsummer, has variable, white-eyed, mid-blue flowers, to 3in (7cm) across, in spikes 2–3ft (70–100cm) long. Z3–8

D. ‘Blue Lagoon’. See *D. Langdon’s Blue Lagoon*’.

D. ‘Blue Nile’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5–6ft (1.5–1.8m). In midsummer, has rich blue flowers, 2½–3in (6–7cm) across, with lightly blue-streaked, white eyes, in spikes to 34in (85cm) long. Z3–8

D. ‘Bruce’ (illus. p.217). Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5½–7ft (1.7–2.2m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 4ft (1.2m) long, of deep violet-purple flowers, to 3in (8cm) across, silver-flushed toward centers, and with dark brown eyes. Z3–7

D. brunonianum. Upright herbaceous perennial. H and S to 8in (20cm). Hairy stems bear rounded, 3- or 5-lobed leaves. In early summer, flower stems each bear a spike, to 6in (15cm) long, of hooded, single, pale blue to purple flowers, 1⁄16in (4cm) across, with short, black spurs. Good for a rock garden. Z3–7

D. ‘Butterball’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5–5½ft (1.5–1.7m). In midsummer, bears cream-eyed, white flowers, to 3in (8cm) across, overlaid with very pale greenish-yellow, in spikes to 20in (50cm) long. Z3–7

D. ‘Can-can’ (illus. p.217). Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6ft (2m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 30in (75cm) long, of fully double flowers, to 3⁄16in (9cm) across, the outer sepals margined dark blue, the inner sepals purple-mauve with darker veining. Z3–7

D. cardinale. Short-lived, upright herbaceous perennial. H 3–6ft (1–2m), S 2ft (60cm). In summer, bears spikes, 12–18in (30–45cm) long, of single, scarlet flowers, 1⁄16in (4cm) across, with yellow eyes, above palmate, finely divided leaves. Z3–7

D. ‘Centurion Sky Blue’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H to 5ft (1.5m). In summer, bears semidouble, sky-blue flowers, 2½in (6cm) across, with white eyes, in spikes to 2ft (60cm) long. Z3–7

D. ‘Chelsea Star’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6ft (2m). Bears rich deep violet flowers, 2½–3in (6–8cm) across, with white eyes, in spikes to 3½ft (1.1m) long, in midsummer. Z3–7

D. ‘Cherub’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 7ft (2.2m). In midsummer, bears branching spikes, 2ft (60cm) long, of long-stalked, semidouble, mauve-pink flowers, with white eyes. Z3–7

D. chinense. See *D. grandiflorum*.

D. ‘Claire’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 4½ft (1.4m). In midsummer, semidouble, pale mauve-pink flowers, to 2in (5cm) across, with cream to pale brown eyes, are borne in spikes to 22in (55cm) long. Z3–8

D. ‘Clifford Sky’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6ft (2m). In midsummer, bears semidouble, white-eyed, sky-blue flowers, to 3in (7.5cm) across, in spikes to 3ft (1m) long. Z3–8

D. ‘Cliveden Beauty’ (illus. p.217). Belladonna Group herbaceous perennial. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m). In early to midsummer, bears spikes, 1ft (30cm) long, of sky-blue flowers, ¾–1¼in (2–3cm) across. Z3–7

D. consolida. See *Consolida ajacis*.

D. ‘Conspicuous’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m). In midsummer, produces semidouble, pale mauve and blue flowers, 2–2½in (5–6cm) across, with prominent dark eyes, in dense spikes, to 2ft (60cm) long. Z3–7

D. ‘Crown Jewel’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m). In summer, produces spikes, to 34in (85cm) long, of semidouble, pale blue and mauve flowers, to 2in (5cm) across, with deep brown eyes. Z3–8

D. ‘Dunsden Green’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 4½ft (1.3m). Spikes, 2ft (60cm) long, of semidouble, lime-green-suffused, white flowers, to 2in (5cm) across, with small, green eyes, are produced in midsummer. Z3–8

D. elatum ‘Sweethearts’. Sturdy,

Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H to 5ft (1.5m). In early to midsummer, bears spikes of semidouble, deep and pale rose-pink flowers, with white eyes. Z6–10

D. ‘Elizabeth Cook’ (illus. p.217). Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5–5½ft (1.5–1.7m), S 1½ft (45cm). In midsummer, bears white flowers, 2½in (6cm) across, in spires that gradually taper toward the tips. Z3–7

D. ‘Emily Hawkins’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6–7ft (2–2.2m). Semidouble, purple-mauve flowers, to 2½in (6cm) across, with light yellowish-brown eyes are borne in midsummer in spikes to 32in (80cm) long. Z3–7

D. ‘Fanfare’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6–7ft (2–2.2m). In midsummer, bears spikes, 2–2½ft (60–75cm) long, of pale blue to silvery-mauve flowers, 2½–3in (6–7cm) across, with white-and-violet eyes. Z3–7

D. ‘Faust’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H to 6ft (1.8m). In summer, bears semidouble, deep cornflower-blue flowers, overlaid with purple, and with indigo eyes, to 3in (8cm) across, in spikes to 3ft (1m) long. Z610

D. ‘Fenella’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 3–5½ft (1–1.6m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 3ft (1m) long, of purple-flushed, gentian-blue blooms, 2–2½in (5–6cm) across, with black eyes. Z3–7

D. ‘Foxhill Nina’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 4ft (1.2m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 2ft (60cm) long, of semidouble, white-eyed, pale pink flowers, 2–2½in (5–6cm) across. Z3–7

D. ‘Galileo’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6ft (1.8m). In early and mid-summer, bears tapering spikes, to 32in (80cm) long, of semidouble, violet-blue flowers, 3in (7cm) across, paling slightly toward the center, with brownish-black eyes. Z3–7

D. ‘Gemini’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6ft (1.8m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 34in (85cm) long, of semidouble, pale violet flowers, to 3in (7.5cm) across, edged reddish-violet with dark black-brown eyes, and white near the center. Z3–7

D. ‘Gemma’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6ft (2m). Semidouble, pale lavender flowers, to 3in (7.5cm) across, with white eyes, are borne in midsummer in spikes to 3ft (1m) long. Z3–8

D. ‘Gillian Dallas’ (illus. p.217). Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6½ft (2.1m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 3ft (90cm) long, of blue-violet flowers, to 3in (8cm) across, with white eyes and violet flecks. Z3–7

D. ‘Giotto’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 5½–6ft (1.7–2m). In midsummer, bears spikes, to 32in (80cm) long, of semidouble flowers, to 3in (7.5cm) across, with deep purple inner sepals, dark blue outer sepals, and light yellow-brown eyes. Z3–8

D. ‘Gordon Forsyth’. Elatum Group herbaceous perennial. H 6ft (2m). In midsummer, produces spikes, 24–28in (60–70cm) long, of semidouble, amethyst-purple blooms, 2½–3in (6–7cm) across, with violet-flecked, black eyes. Z3–7

D. grandiflorum, syn. *D. chinense*. **‘Blue Butterfly’** (illus. p.217), H 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm), is a short-lived, erect